

DARKLANTERN UDP/9992 VISIBILITY

Firewall telemetry validation for traffic directed to the source-documented router backdoor listener. Port metadata is not proof of probe, command execution, implant presence, or compromise.

VALIDATION QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM



PERIMETER LOG

tuple + action + NAT context

ROUTER WAN

ownership must be verified

REPORT DATE

31 August 2026

STATUS

Untested implementation
sketch

PRIMARY TELEMETRY

Microsoft Sentinel /
CommonSecurityLog

ATT&CK

None assigned to port
metadata

The experiment establishes visibility and destination ownership. Payload-aware IDS or PCAP is required to distinguish the DARKLANTERN protocol.

CONTROLLED EIGHT-PAGE THREAT DOSSIER



EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision-grade summary and strict evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.1

A fast way to prove whether perimeter telemetry can scope exposure to a source-documented firmware backdoor.

CLASSIFICATION

Campaign-specific network artifact

Validation query - Untested implementation sketch. Never treat UDP/9992 alone as compromise.

203instances observed

22countries

16router models

0production rules

Source fact

infosrvd listens on UDP/9992; the default router firewall allows Internet inbound access.

Analytical meaning

Firewall metadata can validate visibility and asset scope, but cannot identify packet type or delivery.

Assumptions

An upstream firewall exports traffic events and NAT or inventory resolves the destination to an owned router.

Promotion boundary

Port-only evidence is insufficient for alerting. Add destination ownership and payload-aware IDS/PCAP before considering detection logic.



THREAT MECHANICS

Source-supported protocol and the observable SIEM boundary.

BEHAVIOR

01 Inbound packet

Internet traffic reaches router UDP/9992.

→

02 Info probe

A documented 19-byte packet requests device identity.

→

03 Response

The device returns details to UDP/8897.

04 Command packet

A separate packet type carries a shell string.

→

05 Bypass

Static checksum and all-zero MAC defeat controls.

→

06 Root execution

The service can pass attacker content to `system()`.

Observable	Source support	Sentinel use
UDP destination port 9992	Directly documented	Required filter
19-byte probe	Packet published	Unavailable
UDP/8897 response	Directly documented	Not correlated
Command payload	Reverse-engineered	Unavailable

ATT&CK decision

No technique is assigned. A destination port event alone does not establish scanning, exploitation, command execution, or C2.



TELEMETRY & EVIDENCE MODEL

Minimum data contract and topology dependencies.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

CommonSecurityLog

CEF traffic events from the firewall or security appliance that observes packets before they reach router WAN addresses.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

Router inventory, public/private NAT mapping, model and firmware, IDS/Suricata, PCAP, NetFlow and approved test context.

Field	Reliability	Purpose
TimeGenerated	Documented	Event time
Protocol, DestinationPort	Documented	Direct validation filter
SourceIP, DestinationIP	Documented	Network tuple and ownership pivot
DeviceAction, SimplifiedDeviceAction	Environment-dependent population	Allow/deny interpretation
CommunicationDirection, interfaces	Environment-dependent population	Topology validation
Translated address/port	Environment-dependent population	NAT reconstruction

Unavailable through this query

Packet length and payload, probe versus command distinction, response content, router process, firmware implant, successful execution, and compromise.

Coverage failure

A directly exposed router with no upstream logging, a DCR that excludes traffic events, empty CEF fields, or unresolved NAT makes the experiment inconclusive.



VALIDATION LOGIC

Direct port metadata retrieval with no threshold or alert semantics.

KQL

HYPOTHESIS

If an actor scans, probes, or accesses the documented listener, perimeter telemetry should show UDP traffic with destination port 9992 toward a router WAN address. Legitimate overlap is resolved through ownership, direction, NAT, destination role, and payload-aware evidence.

KQL - UNTESTED VALIDATION

```
CommonSecurityLog
| where Protocol =~ "UDP"
| where DestinationPort == 9992
| project TimeGenerated,
    DeviceVendor, DeviceProduct, DeviceName,
    CommunicationDirection,
    SourceIP, SourcePort,
    DestinationIP, DestinationPort,
    DestinationTranslatedAddress, DestinationTranslatedPort,
    Protocol, DeviceAction, SimplifiedDeviceAction,
    DeviceInboundInterface, DeviceOutboundInterface,
    Message
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

THRESHOLD	WINDOW	JOIN	KEY	STATUS
None	Analyst-selected	None	Network tuple	Untested

Why Microsoft Sentinel

Documented CEF network fields enable raw visibility validation. The query does not assume action values, populated direction, or vendor-specific NAT semantics.



TRIAGE & INVESTIGATION

Turn a metadata match into defensible evidence.

WORKFLOW

1

Verify coverage

Confirm the reporting device and that it sits on the traffic path.

2

Resolve destination

Map public and translated addresses to a specific owned router.

3

Interpret action

Use the raw vendor action and interface context; do not infer delivery.

4

Validate asset

Collect model, firmware, supply-chain identity and change history.

5

Add payload evidence

Use authorized IDS/PCAP to distinguish probe, command, response, or benign UDP.

Escalate

Owned affected router, allowed traffic, source-published payload signature, or matching response.

Benign

Authorized scan or documented application with confirmed owner and change record.

Inconclusive

Unresolved NAT, missing action, no inventory, or metadata-only historical event.

Response boundary

Do not isolate or block based only on the port. If an affected router is confirmed, prioritize replacement or isolation because firmware integrity cannot be established from the SIEM event.



FALSE POSITIVES & VALIDATION

What must be proven before any alert design.

QUALITY CONTROL

SCENARIO	OVERLAP	DISPOSITION
Internet background scanning	H	Asset and payload validation
Authorized vulnerability scan	M	Verify scanner ownership and window
Custom legitimate UDP service	M	Confirm application owner and destination role
DARKLANTERN protocol	L	Require payload or affected-device corroboration

Validation steps

1. Confirm CEF traffic-event ingestion and source topology.
2. Generate an authorized benign UDP/9992 sample.
3. Validate protocol, port, IP, action, direction and NAT population.
4. Measure production overlap and disposition every destination.

Decision criteria

Success: test event appears and destinations map to assets.

Rejection: legitimate use is high and not separable.

Failure: no event, empty fields, or unresolved topology.

No port allowlist

Tuning must use verified asset role, owner, NAT mapping, approved scanner context and packet evidence. Never suppress the entire destination port globally.



CONCLUSION & REFERENCES

Coverage statement, cross-platform limits and document control.

FINAL

CONCLUSION

A useful visibility experiment, not a compromise detector.

The listener and port are directly source-supported and the Sentinel fields are documented. Environmental topology, CEF population and benign overlap still require proof; payload-aware telemetry is the promotion gate.

Cross-SIEM decision

Splunk: no reliable SPL without a verified firewall raw source, index, sourcetype and tuple/action/NAT extractions.

Chronicle: no reliable YARA-L without a verified parser, event type and UDM principal/target network semantics.

Deferred ideas

Port-only alerting, UDP/9992-to-8897 correlation, UDP/10000 SPEAKINGSTONE logic, sinkhole/C2 domains, router file hashes, and untested Suricata deployment.

References

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Document control

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